CHARACTER BOOKLET · No. 13

Morgan *Feld*

COOKBOOK EDITOR

"You can fix any recipe with a red pencil, and most people with a kind word."



FOR YOUR EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER · IN EVERY GAME

WHAT TO WEAR

Dress style: a knit dress, reading glasses on a chain and a red pencil tucked behind one ear.

Suit style: a cardigan over a collared shirt, reading glasses on a chain and the same red pencil.

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Cranberry sauce

Store-bought is fine. Bring it in a dish you love and set it by your table tent.

How this booklet works

Before guests arrive: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Appetizers · Round 1: when the host starts Round 1, open page 3.

The Main Course · Round 2: the lower half of page 3.

Pie · Round 3: page 4. Then everyone votes over coffee.

Accusation over coffee: fill in your ballot. Then the truth is read aloud.

Printing? Single-sided, please, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE GATHERING

The tenth annual Friendsgiving at Juniper Barn. Before the meal, cooking-show star Marigold "Goldie" Ashby tasted the first spoonful of gravy from her antique silver gravy boat, said she felt tired, settled into the rocking chair and never woke up. Every guest brought a dish. Every guest had a reason.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

Your Secret Page

You are the culprit.

You stirred crushed sleeping tablets into Goldie's gravy boat. Nobody must find out.

Your cover story: At 5:35 you went out to your car in the front lot to answer emails from the publisher with the dome light on, and you came back in just before six.

Your story and your secret

For three years you have looked after the cookbook's royalty account, and you quietly borrowed $3,600 from it to keep your tiny press, Feld & Fern, afloat. Goldie's sale needed a royalty statement. Goldie found the gap and told you: tell everyone before my announcement, or I will. At about 5:00 in the hall, Jules joked that a bottle of sleeping tablets was in Jules's coat pocket, "in case the pie doesn't knock me out."

What really happened

- 5:33: you picked up your tote of cookbook proofs and slipped out of the hall into the mudroom while Casey was filming nearby. You took Jules's tablets from Jules's coat and climbed the ladder to the hayloft.
- 5:35–5:50: in the hayloft you crushed the tablets inside a folded proof page by your phone's flashlight. At about 5:38 someone came into the mudroom below, jingled some keys and went out the side door. You kept still.
- 5:50: you climbed down, slipped through the pantry's back door, stirred the powder into the gravy boat under Goldie's napkin and slipped out again.
- 5:51–5:58: back in the hayloft you wrapped the empty bottle in the proof page and pushed it into a hay bale. At 5:59 you walked into the hall for the first taste.

Your goal

Don't get caught. Point suspicion at Jules (the tablets), Quinn (the muddy prints) and Sage (another "M."). Win Best Performance.

If someone asks you…

"Where were you at ten to six?" → "In my car with the publisher's emails." If someone mentions Casey's video: "Fine, I was reading proofs in the hayloft."

"Who has the proofs?" → "I do. My tote sat on the bench by the coats all evening. Anyone could have torn out a page."

"What about the royalties?" → "The statement is nearly finished. The bank is slow."

> PLAYING TIP
>
> Stay relaxed. Use true details wherever you can. You may lie about yourself, but never change what an evidence card says.

Appetizers • *Round 1*

ROUND 1 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 1.

Share

- You have edited The Juniper Barn Cookbook since the first edition, mostly for love.
- Goldie asked you to bring the proofs tonight so everyone could see the new cover.

KEEP QUIET FOR NOW · The royalty account.

Ask

- **Jules:** "Goldie said she was worried about you. Is everything all right?"
- **Avery:** "Is the barn's name really yours to keep?"

Your mission

Compliment Sage's pie, then ask, sweetly, whether Goldie ever judged it a little too closely.

NOTES

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE HOST

The Main Course • *Round 2*

ROUND 2 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 2.

Share

- Your cover story: at 5:35 you went out to your car in the front lot to answer the publisher's emails, and came back just before six.
- Point out that Jules's tablets are missing (Evidence #8) and that the muddy prints (Evidence #6) aren't yours.

Ask

- **Quinn:** "Those muddy prints in the mudroom are yours, aren't they?"
- **Jules:** "Why bring sleeping tablets to a dinner party?"

Your mission

Offer to read Evidence #7 aloud and sound shocked, then steer the talk back to Jules's coat.

NOTES

Pie • *Round 3*

ROUND 3 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 3.

Share

- If the proofs come up (Evidence #9 and #10): your tote sat on the bench in the mudroom all evening, so anyone could have torn out a page.
- Remind everyone that "M." could just as easily be Sage Montrose (Evidence #11 and #12).

Ask

- **Sage:** "You're M. Montrose. What did Goldie want to talk to you about?"
- **Casey:** "Wasn't Goldie about to leave your show?"

Your mission

Stay calm. Offer to fetch coffee for anyone who seems suspicious of you, and keep smiling.

Who's who (public info · optional characters may not be playing)

10 Avery Quill
Barn owner & this year's host · *Roasted pumpkin soup*

11 Sage Montrose
Three-time pie contest champion · *Maple pecan pie*

12 Quinn Delacroix
Owner of Delacroix Cider Mill · *Hot spiced apple cider*

13 Morgan Feld
Cookbook editor · *Cranberry sauce*

14 Casey Thornbury
Producer of Supper with Goldie · *Mushroom stuffing*

15 Jules Carraway
Goldie's cousin · *Cheesy scalloped potatoes*

16 Harper Lindqvist (OPT.)
Farmers' market grower · *Roasted root vegetables*

17 Skyler Bontempo (OPT.)
Food truck owner · *Cornbread*

18 Arden Fairweather (OPT.)
The neighbor next door · *Green bean casserole*

19 Indigo Pike (OPT.)
Turkey farmer · *Roast turkey*

20 Charlie Okonjo (OPT.)
Cheese shop owner · *Autumn cheese board*

21 Wren Abernathy (OPT.)
Goldie's old roommate · *Homemade dinner rolls*

NOTES